



ESCALATED THREAT

Rescue Group Supervisor (RGS):

1. Located between Warm and Cold zone
2. May need LAW for personnel security
3. Determine RTF staging location
4. Ensure RTF has Force Protection
5. Confirm Green Light with IC
6. Provide initial briefing and direction to RTF's
7. Maintain accountability of RTF's
8. Assign a RTF to the CCPs
9. Communicate and relay hazards to IC and RTF's

Rescue Group Assistant (RGA):

1. Stay with RGS
2. Communicate info from RGS to IC
3. Communicate with CCP
4. Coordinate tactical transport for CCP's with IC
5. Maintain accountability



ESCALATED THREAT

Rescue Task Force (RTF):

- 1. Communicate directly to RGS**
 - a. Utilize TAC Channel for communications
 - b. Advance until you reach a stop point
 - c. Perform Treatment and Triage
 - d. Have force protection at all times
 - e. Maintain situational awareness
 - f. Communicate hazards (IED, Weapons)
 - g. Use glow sticks
 - i. RED – Hazards
 - ii. GREEN – Marks Diseased patients
 - iii. BLUE/WHITE – Mark paths of travel every 30'-50'
 - h. Consolidate patients at CCPs
 - i. Declare CCP's and relay to RGS
 - j. Declare RED light condition if warm zone turns into HOT zone
 - i. Insure Force Protection is in place
 - ii. Insure protected Route for Escapes
 - iii. Retreat to Warm Zone



Rescue

The Incident Commander sets the tone for the successful management of this incident by implementing a command structure, giving clear objectives and assignments, and coordinating the activities of various responders.

Command and Control

The incident command system is the framework for managing any incident. Prior training in ICS is important so everyone knows where they fit into the system. ICS should be used to manage all phases of the rescue operation. Small incidents can be managed by one person wearing all the hats. The ICS expands as the incident grows to maintain an efficient span of control. Incidents that involve more than one jurisdiction may be managed by Unified Command.

General Information:

The successful outcome of a technical rescue incident is dependent upon all personnel working within the Incident Management System (IMS) under direction of the Rescue Group Leader who in turn reports to the on scene Incident Commander (IC). The Incident Management System provides safety, accountability of personnel, communications, direction, an action plan and set roles, each with delegated responsibilities.

First Arriving Unit:

The role of the first arriving unit to a rescue based incident includes:

1. Perform a scene size up to determine exactly what the incident entails.
2. Stabilize the incident by providing site control and scene management to prevent additional accidents.
3. Establish command in order to initiate incident organization **OR**
4. Pass command in the event immediate action is required commensurate with your level of training.
5. Declare on air that the incident involves rescue. (HI/LOW Angle, Trench, Confined Space, Swiftwater, Structural Collapse)
6. Determine if operations will commence a Rescue or Recovery Mode.
7. Perform a Risk/Benefit Analysis.
8. Order Resources.



Scene Size Up:

Performing a scene size up will help determine the scope of magnitude of the incident and provide direction on the best approach for formulation an action plan. Many factors may impact the simplicity or complexity of a technical rescue involving rope rescue, and information gathered during the scene size up may include but not limited to:6ghy

1. Determine the number and location of patients.
2. Determine how best to provide scene security.
3. Determine the stability of the ground relative to the area surrounding and above the patients' location.
4. Determine the impact of environmental factors.
5. Determine any impact from exposure to utilities.
6. Determine access points to the patient(s).
7. Determine location and type of anchors available to be utilized.
8. Determine the slope profile.
9. Determine the needs of the patient(s).
10. Determine how best to meet the needs of the patient(s).
11. Determine Rescue or Recovery Mode.
12. Perform a Risk/Benefit Analysis.
13. Determine equipment required/equipment available.
14. Determine resources required/resources available.

Determining Patient Needs:

Determination of patient needs begins by making contact with the patient and/or witnesses. This contact will provide crucial information necessary in order to formulate an action plan. The Immediate needs of a patient are twofold; first determine if the patient is injured or not and second, determine if the patient is in a stable position.

If a patient is injured, try to ascertain the extent and severity of the injuries.

This information is vital not only in dictating the course of patient care; it also starts the clock for weighing out how rapid of retrieval is required. If the patient is in a precarious position and exposed to the possibility of a secondary fall, immediate action from the rescuers proportionate to their level of training will be required.



Rescue / Recovery Mode

Making a determination if operations will commence under Rescue or Recovery Mode shall be ascertained prior to initiating operations. This determination will affect the urgency and pace of the incident. If termination is made to operate in the Rescue Mode, it is based on the belief that there is a viable patient that must be retrieved, but only at a pace reflective of the ability of the rescuers to safely perform the operation proportionate to the level of training that they have received.

A recovery operation is based on the recognition that the patient is not viable. A recovery operation is a more calculated event conducted at a slower pace when a sufficient number of trained personnel are available to safely mitigate the event. The safety of all rescuers is of paramount importance; therefore no undue exposure of risk to rescuers is acceptable at any time for the recovery of a body.

Risk/Benefit Analysis:

Determination to operate in the Rescue Mode shall be accompanied by a Risk/Benefit Analysis. A Risk/Benefit Analysis is based on weighing the degree of risk that rescuers will be exposed to vs. the benefits to be gained for taking those risks. A Risk/Benefit Analysis therefore measures the ability of the rescuers to resolve the exposure to danger that the patient faces, but only at a pace that balances the safety of the rescuers to the necessity to limit the amount of time that the patient is exposed to danger.

Slope Profile:

Evaluation of the slope in its entirety is necessary to help determine how best to retrieve the patient in a sloped environment. This "slope profile" includes the blending of information relating to the angle of the slope, what the surface of the slope consists of, and the run out of the slope. (Example: a slope of 30 degrees with a dry dirt surface may be easily walked up unassisted, if the same 30 degree slope runs out over a cliff or has a wet grass or loose gravel surface, a different approach will be required due to the differences of the slope profile.)

Low Angle Rescue:

A low angle slope can be defined by angle as a slope between 0 and 30 degrees. In rope rescue, this is an environment in which a rope may be required, but serves the function as a belay only and not to haul the rescuers and patient up slope. On a low angle slope, all of the weight of the load from the rescuers and patient is on the ground and if the rescuers and patient is on the ground and if the rescuers slipped without a rope present, they would not be impacted by injuries from an uncontrollable fall.



The use of a single rope may be utilized on a low angle slope to provide support to a litter team. This scenario most typically comes into play for a litter team retrieving a packaged patient from a vehicle accident down an embankment that needs minimal support to assist footling and to regain the top of the embankment. If a low angle slope is impacted by a hazardous run out and/or an unstable surface, a Risk/Benefit evaluation should require the use of a two-rope system.

The number of rescuers that may be utilized as part of a litter team on a low angle rescue is between four and six. Four litter tenders (two per side), is the most typical arrangement for carrying a patient with the addition of a fifth member, if available or necessary, at the tail of the litter to provide additional assistance as required. Six members may be necessary for a very heavy patient; however the use of six litter tenders (three per side) typically can cause more difficulty than benefit as the additional litter tenders may hamper extrication due to stepping on one another's feet and/or throwing each other off balance as they attempt to coordinated synchronized movement.

Medium Angle Rescue:

A medium angle slope can be defined by angle as a slope 30 and 45 degrees. In rope rescue, this is an environment in which a two-rope system protects the rescuers from falling and also provides assistance to the rescuers in regaining the top of the slope. On a medium angle slope, the majority to all of the weight of the load from the rescuers and patient is still on the ground, and the two-rope system prevents falling down slope, as well as assisting the rescuers with regaining the top of the slope.

The use of a two-rope system is required from a medium angle rescue. One rope (Main Line) provides fall protection to the rescuer or litter team during a lowering operation and also with mechanical advantage assistance to personnel operating the Main Line to return the litter team to the top. The second rope (Belay Line) acts as a redundant line in case of Main Line failure, and also as a necessary belay when the Main Line is in motion or resetting.

The number of rescuers that may be utilized as part of a litter team on a medium angle rescue is either three or four depending on slope profile.

Four litter tenders (two per side), may be utilized on shallower angled slopes on a medium angle rescue. As the slope becomes steeper, or the footing is so poor that the load from the rescuers and patient is transferred more from the ground to the rope system, the number of litter tenders must drop to three (one per side and one on the tail end of the litter), to lessen the amount of load that impacts the rope system. All rescuers and the patient are connected at two points on the system.



High Angle Rescue:

A high angle slope can be defined by angle as a slope between 45 and 60 degrees. In rope rescue, this is an environment in which a two-rope system protects the rescuers from falling and is usually required to allow the rescuers to regain the top of the slope. On a high angle slope, the weight of the rescuers and patient is predominately focused onto the two rope system. If the rope system was not present, an uncontrollable fall could possibly impact the rescuers and/or they would not be able to regain the top of the slope on their own.

The use of a two-rope system (Main and Belay Line) is required for a high angle rescue. The only exception to a two-rope system for a high angle rescue falls under the need to perform an immediate rescue and only in extenuating circumstances as detailed below under "Immediate access of a patient".

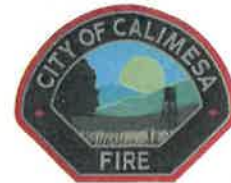
The number of rescuers that may be utilized as part of a litter team on a high angle rescue is three. Three litter tenders positioned one per side and one on the tail end of the litter provides balance in supporting the weight of the patient in the litter and maintains minimal impact potential from the load upon the rope systems. All rescuers and the patient are connected at two points on the system.

Vertical Rescue:

A vertical angle rescue can be defined by angle as a slope greater than 60 degrees to completely vertical. In rope rescue, this is an environment in which a two-rope system protects the rescuer and patient from a fall certain to cause injury or death, and the rope system is the only way possible for the rescuer and patient to regain the top of the slope. In vertical rescue, the weight of the rescuer and patient is completely reliant upon the rope system.

The use of a two-rope system (Main and Belay) is required for vertical rescue. The only exception to a two-rope system for vertical rescue falls under the need to perform an immediate rescue and only in extenuating circumstances as detailed below under "Immediate success of a patient".

The number of rescuers that may be utilized as part of a litter team on a vertical rescue is zero, one, two, or three. If a litter is oriented horizontally with the rope systems attached above the litter, only one tender is necessary to keep the litter from striking the vertical wall and/or to maintain the patient's airway. If the litter is oriented horizontally and suspended from a high line or from a high pick point (such as an aerial apparatus) and the patient does not require the medical support, the decision to not

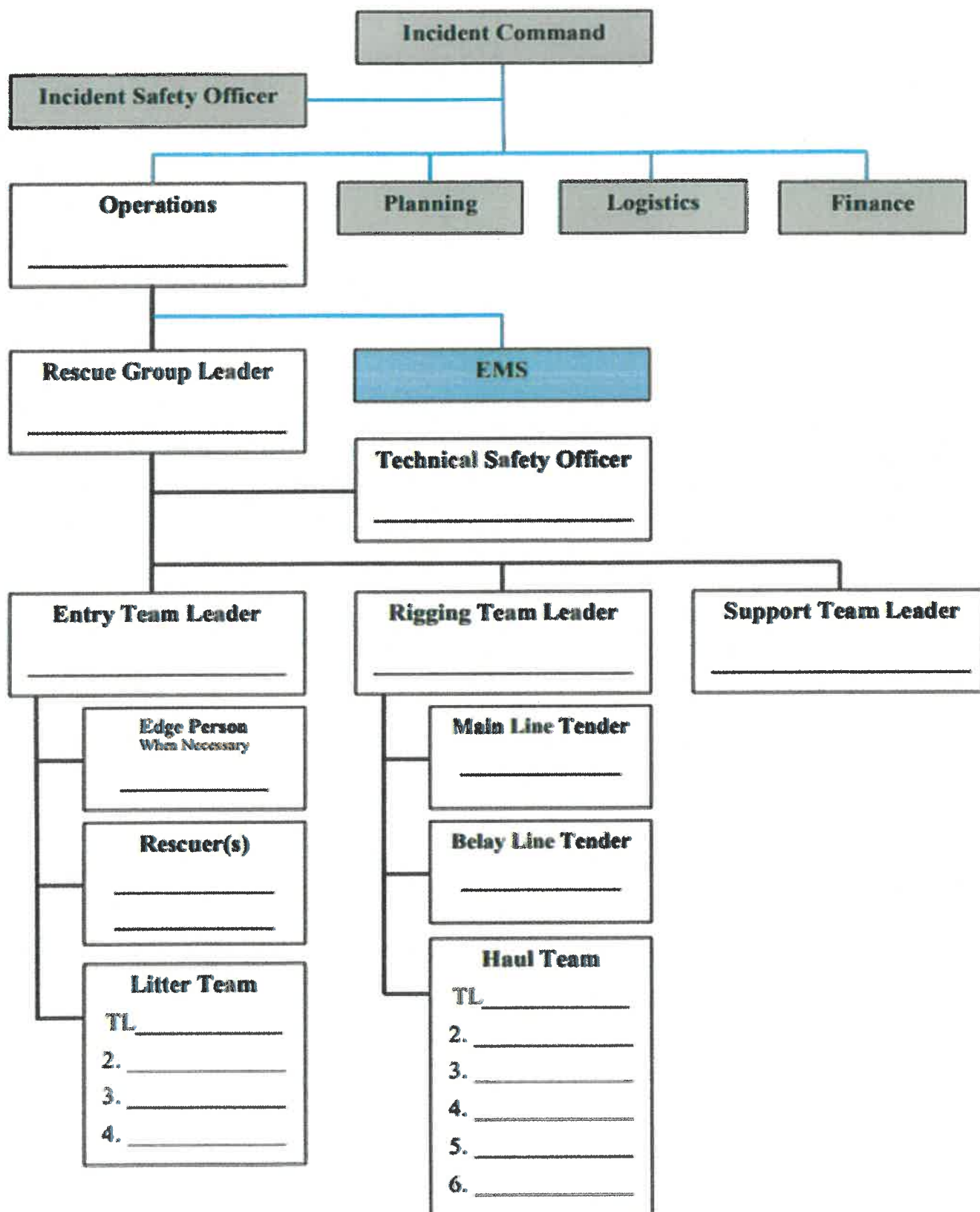


utilize a tender may be dictated by a Risk/Benefit Analysis. The use of a tag line attached to the litter may be necessary to prevent the litter from spinning back and forth around the ropes that the litter is suspended from. A maximum of two persons (rescuer and patient) are allowed on a litter oriented horizontally with the rope systems attached to a harness above the litter.

Two litter tenders may be utilized in unique circumstances positioned on per side on a very steep angled slope, or in areas with limited space such as airshafts. The rope systems in such cases will be attached at the head of the litter. The location of the two litter tenders in this situation is slightly towards the tail end of the litter from the centerline of the litter, in balance with the rope, which holds the head of the litter up. Three litter tenders may still be utilized on a slope is necessary. The rope systems in such cases will still be attached at the head of the litter.

Transitioning Angle Rescue:

If the slope transitions in angle, the number of litter tenders allowed on the system may be dictated by what the greatest impact will be to either the litter tenders or to the rope system.





Rescue

RESCUE SIZE UP:

- Confirm Rescue Type
 - Hi/Lo Angle
 - Structural Collapse
 - Trench
 - Confined Space
 - Swiftwater
- Report Obvious Life Hazards
 - To Perris Dispatch
 - To Incoming Resources
- Victim count with triage categories
 - Immediate
 - Delayed
 - Minor
- Description of entrapment and Rescue Plan
- Any hazards > Lock out / Tag out
- Additional resources needed
 - Law enforcement
 - Cooperators – City, County, Utility Co.
- Command Mode:
 - Name of Incident
 - ICP Location
 - Comm Plan
 - Documentation – OSHA, Site Safety
 - Staging Area
- Secure Rescue Site
- Atmospheric Monitoring / Ready at Site



RESCUE – OFFENSIVE STRATEGY

Life Safety

- **Hazard Mitigation / Stabilization**
- **Victim Access**
- **Disentanglement**

Incident Control

- **Package**
- **Removal**



RESCUE PERRIS UPDATE:

- **Confirm Type of Technical Rescue:**
 - **HI/LO Angle**
 - **Structural Collapse**
 - **Trench**
 - **Confined Space**
 - **Swiftwater**
- **Update Victim Count**
- **Rescue Progress**
- **Alarm Assignment Commitment**
- **Additional Alarms Required**



ROPE RESCUE – LOW ANGLE

- Assess for use least complex as possible:
 - Walk out
 - Carry out
 - Use of rope system
- Mitigate hazards and rolling materials
- Resource incident positions

Additional companies support rescue operations as resourced and maintain situational awareness

- Incident positions to be considered:
 - Rescue Group Supervisor
 - Safety Officer
 - Edge Attendant
 - Main line attendant
 - Belay line attendant
 - On-rope rescuers



ROPE RESCUE – HIGH ANGLE

- Assess for use least complex as possible
 - Walk out
 - Carry out
 - Use of Rope System
- Mitigate Hazards and Rolling Material
- Resource Incident Positions

Additional companies support rescue operations as resourced and maintain situational awareness:

- Incident Positions to be considered:
 - Rescue Group Supervisor
 - Safety Officer
 - Edge Attendant
 - Main line Attendant
 - Belay Line Attendant
 - On-Rope Rescuers

1. Establish Medical Group
2. Assess for Helicopter Transport
3. Secure LZ



RESCUE - CONFINED SPACE (Industrial, Mine, Cave)

- **PHASE 1**
 - 1st in Engine provide size up and take command
 - Initiate OSHA Documents and Confined Space Permit
 - Determine confined space type to be resourced by awareness or technician level.
 - Horizontal
 - Vertical
 - Resource Rescue Company
 - Resource Hazmat Company if Necessary
 - Assign Safety Officer
 - Secure Area
- **PHASE 2**
 - Perform LOCK OUT / TAG OUT
 - Assign Supervisor
 - Assign Attendant
 - Assign Entrant
- **PHASE 3**
 - Conduct Atmospheric Monitoring
 - Ventilate space as necessary
 - Determine level of respiratory
- **PHASE 4**
 - Establish rescue system to be used and prepare for entry
 - Establish communications
- **PHASE 5**
 - Conduct victim removal
- **PHASE 6**
 - Incident termination

Account all personnel and equipment

Restore business or workplace services if approved by OSHA

Complete all OSHA documentation and incident reporting



RESCUE (TRENCH)

- **1st in Engine provide size up and take command**
- **Initiate OSHA documents and confined space permit**
- **Resource rescue company and hazmat company if necessary**
- **Assign safety officer and OSHA competent person**
- **Secure Area and establish safe zones**
- **Perform lock out/tag out and secure damaged utilities**
- **Assign supervisor**
- **Assign attendant**
- **Assign entrant(s)**
- **Conduct atmospheric monitoring**
- **Ventilate space as necessary**
- **Determine level of respiratory protection**
- **Establish rescue system to be used and prepare for entry**
- **Establish communications**
- **Conduct victim removal**
- **Incident termination**
 - **Account all personnel and equipment**
 - **Restore business or workplace services if approved by OSHA**
 - **Complete all OSHA documentation and incident reporting**



RESCUE (STRUCTURE COLLAPSE)

- **1st in Engine provide size up and take command**
- **Initiate OSHA Documents and confined space permit**
- **Resource rescue company and hazmat company if necessary**
- **Assign safety officer**
- **Secure area, establish safe zones and perform atmospheric monitoring**
- **Perform structure triage and hazard recognition**
- **Report life hazard alerts to dispatch and incoming resources**
- **Determine need for respiratory protection**
- **Conduct surface rescues of victims easily accessible**
- **Establish recon team and perform building marking**
- **Establish shoring team**
- **Establish cutting team**
- **Establish measure team**



HAZMAT

Hazmat Size-Up

- **Size / Potential of product release**
- **Nature of product release:**
 - Liquid spill
 - Dry powder spill
 - Vapor release
- **Hazard classification**
 - Explosives
 - Gases
 - Flammable/combustible liquids
 - Flammable solids
 - Oxidizers
 - Toxics
 - Radioactive
 - Corrosives
 - Miscellaneous
- **Health or environmental threat**
- **Additional resources required**
- **Operational record**
- **Tactical Objectives of First-In Company Officer**
 - Safety of crew and public
 - Isolate Area & Deny Entry
 - Notify Hazmat Team and Upgrade Response
 - Establish Command & ICP
 - Identify Hazard
 - Action Plan Established



HAZMAT – DEFENSIVE STRATEGY

LIFE SAFETY

- Isolate/Evacuate or Shelter in Place
- Notify and update response
- Identification/Hazard Assessment
- PPE Level and Type

INCIDENT CONTROL

- Confine Product Spread
- Decon



HAZMAT – OFFENSIVE STRATEGY

LIFE SAFETY

- Isolate/Evacuate or Shelter in Place
- Notifications made to:
 - Cooperators
 - FMO Hazmat
 - Identification/Hazard Assessment
 - Develop an action plan
 - PPE Level and type

INCIDENT CONTROL

- Contain Product
- Decon



Hazmat Group Supervisor

Implement Tactical Objectives

1. Ensure Tactical Priorities are followed: SIN CIA PCP DDD
2. Implement phrases of IAP dealing with the Hazmat Group operations
3. Ensure the development of Control Zones & Access Control Points and the placement of appropriate control lines
4. Ensure that current weather data and future weather predictions are obtained
5. Establish environmental monitoring of the hazard site for contaminants
6. Ensure a Site Safety and Control Plan is developed and implemented
7. Assign resources within the Hazmat Group
8. Conduct safety meetings with the Hazmat Group

Provide Situation Reports to IC or OPS

1. Evaluate and recommend public protective action options (evacuation vs. shelter-in-place)
2. Report progress of control operations
3. Report status of resources within the Hazmat Group

Coordination

1. Coordinate with Entry Team Leader – Proper PPE, back-up team (2 in 2 out), communications entry objectives are understood and followed.
2. Coordinate with Decontamination Team Leader – Type of decon for personnel, victims and equipment, proper PPE
3. Coordinate with Site Access Control Leader – Zones and Control points
4. Coordinate with Technical – Reference Leader – interpret data
5. Coordinate with Safe Refuge Area Manager – Control movement of people
6. Coordinate with on-site Hazmat Team – support as needed.



Hazmat Site Access Control Leader

Implement Tactical Objectives

- 1. Obtain briefing from Hazmat Group Supervisor**
- 2. Identify personnel who will execute the Site Access Control Plan**
- 3. Brief personnel on objectives, location of control lines and Access Control Points**
- 4. Oversee Placement of "Exclusion" and "Reduction" zone control lines**
- 5. Ensure that appropriate action is taken to prevent spread of contamination**
- 6. Establish the Safe Refuge Area within the "Reduction" zone and appoint a Safe Refuge Area Manager if needed**
- 7. Ensure that exposed persons are decontaminated prior to leaving the hazard site (Maintain written documentation of monitoring and destination)**
- 8. Maintain observations of any changes in climatic conditions or other circumstances external to hazard site**

Provide Situation Reports to IC or OPS

- 1. Report any significant changes in climatic conditions or other circumstances external to the hazard site**
- 2. Report status of resources within the Site Access Control Team**

Coordination

- 1. Coordinate operations and maintain communications with the Entry Team Leader**
- 2. Coordinate operations and maintain communications with the Decontamination Team Leader**
- 3. Coordinate with the Medical Group for proper separation and tracking of potentially contaminated persons requiring medical attention**
- 4. Coordinate with Safe Refuge Area Manager – Control movement of people**
- 5. Coordinate with Tech/Reference Leader – placement of control lines**



Hazmat Entry Team Leader

Implement Tactical Objectives

1. Supervise entry operations
2. Recommend actions to mitigate the situation within the Exclusion Zone
3. Carry out actions, as directed by the Hazmat Group Supervisor, to mitigate the hazmat release or threatened release.
4. Maintain communications with Team Members
5. Maintain Control of movement of personnel and equipment within the Exclusion Zone, including victims
6. Direct rescue operations, as needed, in the Exclusion Zone

Provide Situation Reports to IC or OPS

1. The progress of entry team operations
2. Resource needs and accountability of assigned personnel
3. Confirmation of product(s) identification and ongoing hazard assessment

Coordination

1. Coordinate and communicate operations with the Decon Leader
2. Coordinate and communicate operations with the Site Access Control Leader & the Safe Refuge Manager (if activated)
3. Coordinate and communicate operations with the Technical Specialist – Hazmat Reference



Hazmat Decon Team Leader

Implement Tactical Objectives

- 1. Supervise the operations of the decontamination element in the process of decontaminating personnel, victims and equipment.**
- 2. Establish the Contamination Reduction Corridor within the Contamination Reduction Zone (CRZ)**
- 3. Identify contaminated people and equipment**
- 4. Maintain control of movement of personnel, victims and equipment within the Contamination Reduction Zone (CRZ)**

Provide Situation Reports to IC or OPS

- 1. The progress of decontamination team operations**
- 2. Resource needs and accountability of assigned personnel**

Coordination

- 1. Coordinate and communicate operations with the Entry Leader**
- 2. Coordinate and communicate operations with the Site Access Control Leader and Safe Refuge Area Manager (if activated)**
- 3. Coordinate and communicate operations with the Technical Specialist – Hazmat Reference**
- 4. Coordinate the transfer of contaminated victims requiring medical attention (after decon) with the Medical Group**
- 5. Coordinate handling, storage and transfer of contaminants within the Contamination Reduction Zone (CRZ)**



Firefighter Safety and Accountability

I. INTRODUCTION

The Calimesa Fire Department responds to incidents that present the potential for high risks to firefighter safety. Personnel who become lost, trapped, injured or otherwise need immediate assistance while working in these high-risk environments may have only minutes to receive help before their chances of survival drop dramatically. The goal of the Calimesa Fire Department is to outline "firefighter down" procedures and to have properly trained and equipped personnel in place before a fire ground emergency. It will be the policy of the Calimesa Fire Department to respond immediately and effectively to any firefighter emergency.

A. PURPOSE

1. To reduce the level of firefighter injury and mortality during emergency incidents where personnel are working in conditions that are Immediately Dangerous to Life or Health. See "Appendix A" for examples of IDLH incidents.
2. To establish a departmental program to track the location and status of all personnel engaged in emergency operations through an effective Personnel Accountability System (P.A.S.)
3. To ensure compliance with the "Two-In, Two Out" rule adopted by the National Fire Protection Association (N.F.P.A.), Occupational Safety and Health Administration (O.S.H.A.) and the California Code of Regulations.
4. To establish a departmental program to provide immediate assistance for personnel who become lost, trapped, injured, have had a catastrophic failure of personal protective equipment or otherwise need immediate assistance while working in an I.D.L.H. environment. This will be done by temporarily providing an Initial Standby Team as needed or a Rapid Intervention Crew Group Supervisor/Rapid Intervention Crew (R.I.C.) when sufficient resources are on scene within the first alarm.
5. To establish a departmental standard of notifying the Incident Commander and all operating units that a "Mayday/Fire Fighter Down" situation is occurring.
6. To establish a departmental standard outlining basic survival techniques for personnel who have become lost, trapped, injured, have had a catastrophic



failure of personal protective equipment or otherwise need immediate assistance while working in an I.D.L.H. environment. Ops Directive 3011 2 of 25 Revised 12/2012

7. To establish an annual departmental didactic and manipulative refresher training program.

B. SCOPE

This directive applies to all personnel working at an emergency incident where an I.D.L.H. environment exists (See "Appendix A").

C. AUTHORITY

The Department's Firefighter Safety and Accountability policy has as its basis O.S.H.A.: 29 CFR, Part 1910.134 (g) (3) & (4), California Code of Regulations: 8 CCR § 5144 (g) (3) & (4) and N.F.P.A. 1500 (2007 Edition). The policy also uses FIRESCOPE document ICS 910 as guidelines to establish a Personnel Accountability System and Rapid Intervention Crews whenever personnel are working in I.D.L.H. environments.

II. RESPONSIBILITY

A. Incident Commanders (I.C.):

1. Ensure the establishment and implementation of the Passport (Pass.) Tag Accountability System on all I.D.L.H. incidents.
2. Ensure compliance with the "Two-In, Two-Out" Rule adopted by O.S.H.A., California Code of Regulations and the N.F.P.A.
3. Temporarily establish an Initial Standby Team on all I.D.L.H. incidents. Upon arrival of adequate resources within the first alarm, the Incident Commander shall designate at least one, three or four-person, company to be the R.I.C. Group Supervisor/R.I.C. It should be the priority of the Incident Commander to make this assignment as soon as possible and may be established in place of the Initial Standby Team. As an incident expands in size or complexity the Incident Commander should consider requesting additional resources to assist with R.I.C. operations.
4. Immediately implementing rapid intervention operations whenever a "Mayday/Fire Fighter Down" situation is reported.



5. Conduct a Personnel Accountability Report (P.A.R.) every 10 minutes of the Incident Clock or any of the following situations: A report of a "Mayday/Firefighter Down" situation, a change in strategy from offensive to defensive (Operational Retreat), any sudden-unexpected incident event (building collapse, explosion, etc.).
6. Developing an Incident Action Plan (I.A.P.) and formulating strategic priorities according to this instruction and other Department Policies.
7. Demobilization of the R.I.C. Group when personnel are no longer exposed to I.D.L.H. conditions.
8. Ensure all appropriate incident documentation is filed at Division Headquarters and forwarded to the Department Safety Officer whenever a fire ground emergency ("Mayday/Firefighter Down" or an incident related injury) occurs. The documentation shall include an Investigation Report, the Incident Action Plan (IAP), C.A.D. call history and Pass Tag Accountability System information. Ops Directive 3011 3 of 25 Revised 12/2012

B. Operations Section Chiefs, Branch Directors, Division/Group Supervisors:

1. Maintain Personnel Accountability within their assigned Branches, Divisions, Groups and Units by use of the Pass. Tag Accountability System.
2. Ensure compliance with the "Two-In, Two-Out" Rule within their area of responsibility.
3. Ensuring that rapid intervention capabilities are appropriate for the level of I.D.L.H. hazards within their area of responsibility.
4. Immediately notifying the Incident Commander of any reported "Mayday/Fire Fighter Down" situations within their area of responsibility.

C. Company Officers/Leaders:

1. Maintain Company Unity and Personnel Accountability by using the Pass. Tag Accountability System.
2. Ensure the Apparatus Tag is accurate and reflects the members assigned to the apparatus at all times.
3. Ensure that each member on the apparatus has the correct helmet magnets reflecting the current apparatus assignment.
4. Comply with the "Two In, Two Out" Rule.



5. Notify the Incident Commander or other assigned supervisor of any "Mayday/Fire Fighter Down" situation, performing an immediate accounting of their company or assigned resources when ordered (P.A.R.), and being prepared to assist with a rapid intervention operation as assigned.

D. All Personnel:

1. Maintaining Company Unity and Personnel Accountability by use of the Pass. Tag Accountability System.
 2. Ensure that your Personnel Tag is affixed to the corresponding Apparatus Tag at the beginning of each shift.
 3. Ensure that your helmet has the correct magnets reflecting your current apparatus assignment.
 4. Keep your supervisor informed of your current location and status always while on the emergency scene. "Freelancing" by individuals shall not be permitted.
 5. Comply with the "Two-In, Two-Out Rule.
 6. Notify your supervisor of any "Mayday/Fire Fighter Down" situation, and be prepared to assist with a rapid intervention operation as assigned.
 7. Be familiar with basic survival techniques when lost, trapped, injured, have suffered a catastrophic failure of your personal protective equipment or otherwise need immediate assistance while working in an I.D.L.H. environment.
- Ops Directive 3011 4 of 25 Revised 12/2012

E. San Bernardino County Communications Center (Perris Dispatch)

1. Shall be responsible to support radio communications during emergency incidents as outlined in this directive.

III. PERSONNEL ACCOUNTABILITY OPERATIONS

A. Passport (Pass.) Tag Accountability System

A procedure that utilizes Personnel Tags, Apparatus Tags and an Accountability Board to track the assignment and location of fire department personnel operating at an emergency incident.

1. Personnel Tag

- a. Made from an aluminum/laminate material with Velcro on the backside. The Personnel Tags will be stored, by Velcro, under the rear



brim of the structural helmet. When assigned to an apparatus the Personnel Tag will be affixed to the corresponding Apparatus Tag.

b. Size is 1/2" x 1 1/2"

c. Shall include first initial and last name in Arial Font, size 12. If necessary, utilize the first and middle initials to differentiate personnel with duplicate names.

d. Colors:

i. Chief Officers Gold with black letters

ii. Captain Red with white letters

iii. Engineer Yellow with red letters

iv. Firefighter White with black letters

v. Limited Term/Paid Call Green with black letters

vi. Non-I.D.L.H. Personnel Grey with black letters

2. Apparatus Tag

a. Made from rigid aluminum with Velcro on the front and backside. The Apparatus Tag will be affixed, by Velcro, in plain sight within the interior of the apparatus cab.

b. Size is 1 1/2" x 3"

c. Agency and Radio Identifier on the top of the tag in Arial Font, size 18.

d. Color is black with white lettering for B.L.S. Units and blue with white lettering for A.L.S. Units.

3. Accountability Board

a. Made from an aluminum/laminate type material. The board will be stored in plain sight within the interior of the apparatus cab.

b. Size is 11" x 14"

c. Shall have Velcro on the front side to receive Apparatus Tags.

d. The reverse side will have the R.I.C. Group Supervisor Tactical Worksheet (Appendix D) printed on it.



- e. Will be laminated so that a grease pencil or wet erase marker can be used to fill it out.

B. Pass. Tag Accountability System Procedures

- 1. Initial Accountability Collection Point** - Typically, this will be inside the cab of the first arriving apparatus unless the incident dictates otherwise. For example, the Accountability Board, with Apparatus Tag attached, would be left on the front passenger seat of the first arriving apparatus before engaging in activities.
2. It shall be the responsibility of the Company Officer/Leader of each assigned unit to report to the designated accountability collection point to hand-off their Apparatus Tag before engaging in their assignment.
3. It shall be the responsibility of the Company Officer/Leader of each assigned unit to collect their Apparatus Tag when exiting the I.D.L.H. environment.
4. If a unit receives an assignment before the establishment of the Initial Standby Team or R.I.C. Group Supervisor/R.I.C., the Company Officer/Leader of that unit shall be responsible to report to the initial accountability collection point to apply the Apparatus Tag of their unit to the Accountability Board.
5. Once assigned to the Initial Standby Team, the member responsible to maintain accountability shall retrieve the Accountability Board from the initial accountability collection point.
 - a. This member will then report to the entry point and maintains accountability until relieved by the R.I.C. Group Supervisor.
 - b. Additional assigned units will then report to the new accountability collection point to hand off their Apparatus Tags.
6. If assigned to the R.I.C. Group Supervisor position and the Initial Standby Team was set up, the R.I.C. Group Supervisor will get a face-to-face report from the member of the Initial Standby Team maintaining accountability.
 - a. The R.I.C. Group Supervisor will now be responsible for maintaining accountability for the duration of the incident.
7. If assigned to the R.I.C. Group Supervisor position and the Initial Standby Team was not set up, the R.I.C. Group Supervisor shall retrieve the Accountability Board from the initial accountability collection point.
 - a. The R.I.C. Group Supervisor will then report to the entry point and maintains accountability for the duration of the incident.



b. Additional assigned units will then report to the new accountability collection point to hand off their Apparatus Tag.

8. On incidents where multiple entry points are needed, it will be the responsibility of the R.I.C. Group Supervisor to request additional companies for R.I.C. from the Incident Commander/Operations Section Chief.

a. They should be assigned to those additional entry points.

b. Designate a member to maintain an Accountability Board.

9. Incidents where it is not practical to hand off Apparatus Tags at the designated accountability collection point (e.g., a large wide-rise commercial building), the Company Officer/Leader of that unit shall notify the member maintaining accountability by radio.

a. Information shall include their unit designator, assignment, number of personnel and entry location.

b. The Apparatus Tag may be left in its normal location on the apparatus.

c. All efforts should be made to hand off the Apparatus Tag at the designated accountability collection point.

10. On large incidents the Incident Commander can delegate an Accountability Officer for the incident.

a. The Accountability Officer will work closely with the Incident Commander/Operations Section Chief and the R.I.C. Group Supervisor to track and maintain accountability for all personnel operating at the emergency incident.

b. The R.I.C. Group Supervisor should request an Accountability Officer from the Incident Commander/Operations Section Chief if he or she becomes overwhelmed with their duties.

IV. RADIO PROCEDURES

A. Communications

1. Personnel who are assigned a portable radio must carry it at all emergency incidents. At a minimum the Company Officer/Leader of a crew must possess a portable radio. If a radio fails while working in an I.D.L.H. environment, the crew shall exit the area unless there is another working radio within the crew. However, the crew must remain in communication with each other through visual, voice or physical means.



2. **"Emergency Traffic"** shall be used to clear radio traffic for a significant fire ground event. For example: "All units, I.C.; Emergency Traffic, we've had a building collapse..."

a. All radio traffic shall cease on any channel where "Emergency Traffic" has been requested unless directly related to the "Emergency Traffic" situation.

b. After the event has been reported to or announced by the Incident Commander, he or she shall report the event to Perris Dispatch and request an "Emergency Traffic Alert."

c. Perris Dispatch will broadcast the Emergency Traffic Alert that consists of three short tones and repeats "Emergency Traffic" followed by a concise, clear text, description of the emergency (e.g., Operational Retreat or Mayday/Firefighter Down) on all assigned frequencies.

d. At the conclusion of the "Emergency Traffic" situation, the incident Commander shall transmit "All clear, resume normal radio traffic" to end the emergency and ensure Perris Dispatch is notified.

3. **"Mayday/Firefighter Down"** shall be used to notify the Incident Commander / Operations Section Chief, R.I.C. Group Supervisor, on-scene personnel or Perris Dispatch (Perris Dispatch does not monitor tactical channels unless requested to do so) that a member has become lost, trapped, injured, has had a catastrophic failure of personal protective equipment or otherwise needs immediate assistance while working in an I.D.L.H. environment. For example: "I.C., Calimesa Engine-1; Emergency Traffic, Mayday, Mayday, Mayday/Firefighter Down."

4. Perris Dispatch, at the time of dispatch, shall issue a pre-designated Primary and Alternate Tactical Channel for potential I.D.L.H. incidents.

a. All "normal" fire ground traffic shall use the primary tactical channel.

b. The alternate tactical channel shall be for fire ground traffic to switch to in the event of a "Mayday/Firefighter Down."

i. Shall only be used for this purpose, not as a secondary tactical channel.

ii. Perris Dispatch will advise all units not directly involved in the rescue to switch to the alternate tactical channel during their Emergency Traffic Alert for the "Mayday/Firefighter Down."



- c. All units involved with the rescue, including the downed member(s), will remain on the primary tactical channel.

B. **"Incident Clock"** - Perris Dispatch shall start an Incident Clock when the first arriving unit is on scene of an I.D.L.H. incident. It will be referred to as the "Incident Clock" on the radio.

1. Perris Dispatch shall notify the Incident Commander at every 10-minute increment with the time that resources have been on the incident (e.g., "Incident Clock" is at 10, 20 or 30 minutes), until the I.D.L.H. environment has been mitigated. (N.F.P.A. 1500 8.2.4)
2. The Incident Commander should cancel the Incident Clock when the incident has been declared under control and the I.D.L.H. situation no longer exists.

C. **"Personnel Accountability Report (P.A.R.)"** shall be used to indicate the process of conducting a rapid "roll call" of all companies, units and individuals on an emergency incident. When requested, an immediate location and status report including unit name and number of personnel shall be forwarded to the appropriate I.C.S. supervisor.

1. Shall be initiated by the Incident Commander/Operation Section Chief for the following events:
 - a. Every ten minutes of the Incident Clock (N.F.P.A. 1500 8.2.4)
 - i. After the P.A.R. has been completed communicate results and declare strategy mode (offensive or defensive) back to Perris Dispatch . For example: "Perris Dispatch , I.C.; We have accountability for all units. We're in the offensive mode continue the Incident Clock."
 - ii. If an I.D.L.H. environment no longer exists cancel the Incident Clock. Ops Directive 3011 8 of 25 Revised 12/2012
 - b. "Mayday/Firefighter Down" situation
 - i. As soon as possible after the R.I.C. operation has been initiated.
 - ii. Shall be done on the primary and alternate tactical channels.
 - c. A change in strategy from offensive to defensive (Operational Retreat)
 - d. Any sudden-unexpected incident event (building collapse, explosion, etc.).



2. The Incident Commander shall request that the Initial Standby Team, R.I.C. Group Supervisor or Accountability Officer (if established) conduct the P.A.R. for units assigned within the I.D.L.H. environment.

a. All units with Apparatus Tags on the Accountability Board **MUST** be accounted for.

b. Report P.A.R. results back to the Incident Commander.

3. When receiving the P.A.R. result from the Initial Standby Team, R.I.C. Group Supervisor or Accountability Officer the Incident Commander shall verify that all assigned units have been accounted for.

4. The Incident Commander shall be responsible to conduct the P.A.R. for units that are not on the Accountability Board (i.e., units assigned to staging or non-I.D.L.H. positions).

5. If any personnel or companies are unaccounted for, the Incident Commander shall order a repeated P.A.R. and send a runner to verify accountability if radio problems are suspected.

6. ANY UNREPORTED MEMBER OR COMPANY DURING A P.A.R. SHALL BE ASSUMED LOST OR TRAPPED AND SHALL HAVE R.I.C. OPERATIONS INITIATED TO LOCATE THEM.

D. **"Operational Retreat"** is defined as an evacuation of all personnel operating in hazardous areas at an emergency incident. The operational retreat may be prompted by various situations including imminent safety hazards or a switch from an offensive to defensive attack. Its purpose is to remove crews to safety and to obtain an accurate P.A.R. of on scene members.

1. Normally initiated by the Incident Commander, but may be initiated by Division/Group Supervisor and above.

2. Personnel should not slow their departure from the hazard area to reclaim equipment, tools or hose lines.

3. Each crew should proceed to the nearest exit point and return to their point of entry to a safe zone located a minimum distance of 1 ½ times the height of the building.

4. An **"Evacuation Signal"** will be initiated by Perris Dispatch at the request of the Incident Commander after an Operational Retreat has been ordered. For example: "Perris Dispatch, I.C.; Emergency Traffic. We've had a roof collapse and I've ordered an Operational Retreat. I'd like to request an Evacuation Signal."



- a. Perris Dispatch shall notify on scene personnel of the Operational Retreat by broadcasting an Evacuation Signal with the high-low alert tone (Perris Dispatch Alert 2) for 10 seconds.
- b. Perris Dispatch shall then broadcast an Emergency Traffic Alert followed by an announcement of the Operational Retreat on all assigned frequencies.
- c. In addition, an on scene evacuation signal will consist of repeated short blasts of the air horn for approximately 10 seconds, followed by 10 seconds of silence. This sequence of air horn blasts for 10 seconds followed by a 10 second period of silence will be done three times. Total air horn evacuation signal including periods of silence will last 50 seconds. (FIREScope ICS 910)

V. "MAYDAY/Fire Fighter Down" AND Basic SELF-SURVIVAL Procedures

The rescue of downed firefighters is especially time sensitive. There is a narrow window of survivability for firefighters that have become lost, trapped, injured, have had a catastrophic failure of personal protective equipment or otherwise need immediate assistance. Firefighters must request emergency assistance immediately. Company officers must not delay the reporting of lost firefighters (or inability to account for personnel through a P.A.R.). **STAY CALM!** The person who is going to help you the most is **YOU!**

A. Call for Help Immediately

1. Firefighters who find themselves lost, trapped, injured, have had a catastrophic failure of personal protective equipment or otherwise need immediate assistance while working in an I.D.L.H. environment must immediately follow the "Mayday/Firefighter Down" procedures while they continue to attempt to find their way out.
 - a. Firefighters should not delay notification of distress.
 - b. Notification should occur when the firefighter **THINKS** he or she is in trouble while attempting to exit the I.D.L.H. environment.
 - c. See "Appendix B" for Firefighter Basic Self-Survival Techniques
2. Transmit an "Emergency Traffic, Mayday/Firefighter Down" to report your situation. For example: "IC, Calimesa Engine-1; Emergency Traffic, Mayday, Mayday, Mayday/Firefighter Down".
 - a. Remain on the primary tactical channel.



- b. If unable to make contact on the primary tactical channel, try the command channel.
- c. If still unable to make contact or unable to press push to talk on radio....turn on your P.A.S.S. Device
- d. All efforts to monitor radio traffic should be done.

6663. The individual reporting the "Mayday/Fire Fighter Down" condition shall utilize the acronym LUNAR to report important information about the emergency.

L Location (where are you)?

U Unit (apparatus assigned to)?

N Name (who you are)?

A Assignment/Air Status (what you were doing and remaining air)?

R Resources (what do you need)? Ops Directive 3011 10 of 25 Revised 12/2012

VI. INCIDENT COMMANDER PROCEDURES FOR A "MAYDAY / FIREFIGHTER DOWN"

Upon notification of a "Mayday/Firefighter Down" situation it is imperative that the Incident Commander remains in control of the entire incident and not become overly committed to the rescue activities. By establishing the R.I.C. Group Supervisor/R.I.C. early, it enables the Incident Commander to have the R.I.C. Group Supervisor directly oversee the rescue operation of downed member(s). There are many operational procedures that need to occur in the event of a downed firefighter, along with mitigating the incident, which makes it overwhelming for the Incident Commander to handle both the rescue operation and ensure that the overall incident objectives are met.

A. Notification of a "Mayday/Firefighter Down"

1. Upon notification of a "Mayday/Firefighter Down" the Incident Commander should acknowledge the request for "Emergency Traffic." For example: "IC, Calimesa Engine-1; Emergency Traffic, Mayday, Mayday, Mayday/Firefighter Down." "Calimesa Engine-1, IC; I copy your Emergency Traffic, Mayday/Firefighter Down. Go ahead and give me your LUNAR report."
2. The following information should be obtained from the downed member.

L Location (where are they)?

U Unit (apparatus assigned to)?



N Name (who is it)?

A Assignment/Air Status (what were they doing and their remaining air)?

R Resources (what do they need)?

3. Reassure the downed firefighter and have them remain on their current channel. Advise the member that you will contact the R.I.C. Group Supervisor to activate "R.I.C." and initiate a rapid intervention.

4. Advise the R.I.C. Group Supervisor of the "Mayday/Firefighter Down," giving them the LUNAR report (Section 2 from above). Request that the R.I.C. Group Supervisor activate R.I.C. and initiate the rapid intervention plan.

a. The remaining radio traffic with the downed member(s) during the rescue operation should be with the R.I.C. Group Supervisor and R.I.C.

b. Monitor radio traffic and ensure that the R.I.C. Group Supervisor gives periodic updates on progress and resource needs.

B. Perris Dispatch Notification

1. After the initial notification and the rescue operation has been initiated, advise Perris Dispatch the following: "Perris Dispatch, IC; Emergency Traffic. We've had a Mayday/Firefighter Down off of Calimesa Engine 1, Rescue operations have been initiated."

This is done after the rescue has been initiated so that the Emergency Traffic Alert from Perris Dispatch does not interrupt the transmission of information about the downed member(s).

a. Request an additional alarm(s)

b. Request an appropriate number of Ambulances

i. Ground

ii. Air Ops

2. Perris Dispatch will then broadcast an Emergency Traffic Alert for the "Mayday/Firefighter Down" on all assigned channels and state the following: **"All units on the incident, Perris Dispatch ; Emergency Traffic. There has been a Mayday/Firefighter Down off of Calimesa Engine 1. Rescue operations have been initiated. All units not involved in the rescue switch to the alternate tactical channel (repeat frequency) and standby for a P.A.R."**



- a. The Incident Commander shall initiate a P.A.R. on the primary and alternate tactical channels after the rescue operation has been started.

C. Management of Resources

1. The rescue of a downed firefighter will be a labor-intensive operation. Consideration should be given to reassign resources on scene to the R.I.C. Group to immediately assist with the rapid intervention operation.

- a. Personnel and units that are performing critical operations (e.g., fire attack and ventilation in support of the rapid intervention) SHALL continue those efforts, unless conditions become untenable.
- b. Additional companies will be reassigned to the R.I.C. Group for the purpose of multiple R.I.C. (e.g., R.I.C.-2, R.I.C.-3, R.I.C.-4...etc).
- c. Ensure that the R.I.C. Group Supervisor gives periodic updates on progress and resource needs.
- d. It may be appropriate to assign an Accountability Officer.

2. Resources from the additional alarm(s) shall be used according to incident needs.

- a. Support the rescue operation.
- b. Replenish resources that were reassigned from their original assignment to the R.I.C. Group.
- c. Backfill to allow companies to rehab.
- d. Consideration should be given to assign a Medical Group to oversee and provide medical treatment for any downed member(s).

VI. "TWO-IN, TWO-OUT" RULE / Initial Standby team Operations

A. "Two-in, Two-out" Rule:

1. O.S.H.A. defines an incipient stage fire as one "which is in the initial or beginning stage and which can be controlled or extinguished by portable fire extinguishers, class II standpipe or small hose systems without the need for protective clothing or breathing apparatus." Any structural fire beyond the incipient stage is considered to be an I.D.L.H. atmosphere by O.S.H.A.
2. Personnel operating in hazardous or I.D.L.H. conditions shall operate in teams of two or more.



a. These crews shall be equipped with S.C.B.A. and other appropriate Personal Protective Equipment based on the hazards at the incident scene.

b. They shall be in communication with each other by radio, visual, voice or physical means.

i. Communications between crew members should not rely strictly on radio use due to the potential for radio failure. **Therefore, all members must be equipped with tag lines and remain in proximity to each other.**

3. Upon arrival of the first company, the Incident Commander or the initial Company Officer/Leader shall temporarily designate no less than two members to act as the Initial Standby Team.

4. Considering 29 CFR 1910.134 (g) (Note 2), 8 CCR § 5144 (g) (Note 2) and N.F.P.A. 1500 8.5.17 and 8.5.17.1, the only exception to the "Two-in, Two-out" Rule will be permitted when the first arriving personnel determine the following:

a. There is an imminent life-threatening situation where immediate action (rescue activities) could prevent the loss of life or serious injury.

i. No exception shall be permitted when there is no possibility to save lives.

ii. Unless this "exceptional situation" is met, entry into the hazardous area will require at least four personnel on the scene (i.e., "Two-in, Two-out").

5. Suppression crews arriving for initial attack with less than four personnel shall immediately determine whether an "exceptional situation" to the "Two-in, Two-out" Rule exists.

a. Unless such situation exists, these units shall await the arrival of additional resources with sufficient personnel to temporarily establish a two person Initial Standby Team before committing personnel into the hazardous area.

i. Numerous exterior operations can be performed while waiting for the arrival of additional resources (e.g., performing a 360° survey, softening the structure, securing utilities, setting ladders / fans, deploying hose lines and performing exterior fire attack).



6. Personnel entering a hazard area for a known rescue prior to four members being on scene shall notify the Incident Commander or Perris Dispatch of their impending entry.

7. Upon completion of the incident, the Company Officer/Leader shall document the situation and conditions that led to any deviation from the "Two-in, Two-out" Rule.

- a. The documentation shall be recorded in the N.F.I.R.S. Incident Report.
- b. The narrative section should provide investigation findings, including details of the rescue, safety procedures in place at the time of the rescue and the status of the persons rescued.
- c. A summary of incident times shall also be included.

8. The Incident Battalion Chief or in his or her absence the Duty Battalion Chief shall be responsible to investigate the deviation from the "Two-in, Two-out" Rule.

- a. This Battalion Chief shall also ensure the N.F.I.R.S. report is completed to standard and routed to the Department Safety Officer.
- b. As necessary, the Fire Chief may assign the incident investigation directly to the Department Safety Officer. This process will satisfy the requirement for "a written report submitted to the Fire Chief", as required by N.F.P.A. 1500 8.5.17.2.

B. Initial Standby Team Responsibilities

This team shall be temporarily assigned to "standby" outside the hazardous area in a full state of readiness to provide immediate assistance to entry members if there is a "Mayday/Firefighter Down" situation. They should have a designated leader and should be called "Standby Team" on the radio. The Initial Standby Team allows a four-person company to conduct operations in an I.D.L.H. environment before the arrival of additional units. For example, if the first arriving crew at a fire is a four-person company, the Company Officer may pass command and join one firefighter to form an Entry Crew (Attack Mode). Meanwhile, the other two members will form the Initial Standby Team. **The Incident Commander shall assign a R.I.C. Group Supervisor/R.I.C. to replace the Initial Standby Team when adequate resources arrive on scene within the first alarm.**

- 1. Initial Standby Team Briefing: The Initial Standby Team Leader (Member #1) shall provide a briefing to the crew members to include the following:



- a. Identify current conditions, known hazards, incident layout (i.e. A, B, C, D Sides).
- b. Location of committed personnel.
- c. Plan of action if there is a "Mayday/Firefighter Down" situation.

2. Member #1 shall be responsible for maintaining accountability and communications.

- a. Reports to the initial accountability collection point to get the first arriving units Accountability Board with attached Apparatus Tags.
- b. Establishes the accountability collection point near the point of entry and maintains the Accountability Board.
- c. Conducts the P.A.R. for assigned units within the I.D.L.H. environment when requested to do so by the Incident Commander.
 - i. Contact appropriate I.C.S. Supervisor and request a P.A.R. for their assigned units/members.
 - ii. **MUST** ensure that all units with Apparatus Tags on the Accountability Board are accounted for.
 - iii. Report results of P.A.R. back to Incident Commander. For example: "I.C., Standby Team; We have accountability for the following units: ME-1, ME-2, ME-3...etc."
- d. Maintains radio communications with the entry crew.
 - i. Monitors crew progress
 - ii. Monitors incident conditions
 - iii. Actively monitors radio traffic
- e. Performs a face-to-face briefing when relieved by the R.I.C. Group Supervisor.

3. According to 29 CFR 1910.134 (g) (Note 1), 8 CCR § 5144 (g) (Note 1) and N.F.P.A. 1500 8.5.11, **Member #2 of a two person Initial Standby Team may be permitted to perform other duties.** However, this individual may perform another task only if he or she can leave that position to respond into the hazardous area without jeopardizing other firefighters. For example, they may function as Apparatus Operator, establish minimum equipment cache or "soften" the structure.



- a. Must be in the appropriate Personal Protective Equipment.
- b. Must have S.C.B.A. immediately available for rapid deployment.
- c. Should aid in establishing minimum equipment cache for rescue operations.
- d. Actively monitors radio communications.

C. Initial Standby Team Deployment Procedures

1. Should a "Mayday/Firefighter Down" situation occur the Initial Standby Team should try to obtain the following information from the downed member(s). See "Appendix D" for the R.I.C. Group Supervisor Tactical Worksheet to use as an organizational aid:

L Location (where are they)?

U Unit (apparatus assigned to)?

N Name (who is it)?

A Assignment/Air Status (what were they doing and their remaining air)?

R Resources (what do they need)?

2. The Initial Standby Team Leader or the Incident Commander (if established) will advise Perris Dispatch of the "Mayday/Firefighter Down" situation and that emergency rescue activities have been initiated. For example: "Perris Dispatch , Standby Team; Emergency Traffic, we have a Mayday/Firefighter Down off of Calimesa Engine 1 and are initiating a rescue."

a. Perris Dispatch should be notified after the information has been obtained about the downed member(s). This is done so that the Emergency Traffic Alert from Perris Dispatch does not interrupt the transmission of information about the downed member(s).

b. Perris Dispatch will then broadcast an Emergency Traffic Alert for the "Mayday/Firefighter Down" on all assigned channels and state the following: **"All units on the incident, Perris Dispatch ; Emergency Traffic. There has been a Mayday/Firefighter Down off of Calimesa Engine 1. Rescue operations have been initiated. All units not involved in the rescue switch to the alternate tactical channel (repeat frequency) and standby for a P.A.R."**



3. Prior to entry, the Initial Standby Team Leader should conduct a briefing of the situation and plan of action. Be sure to ensure the following:

- a. Incident layout (e.g., A, B, C, D sides)
- b. The point of entry is the closest to the last known location of the downed firefighter based on the LUNAR report.
- c. All members have the proper Personal Protective Equipment.
- d. All members have the proper tools and equipment.
- e. All members are on the proper radio frequency.

4. Upon entry into the area to be searched, the Initial Standby Team shall remain in a working team of two or more.

- a. Direct rescue efforts shall continue as the safety of the scene dictates.
- b. Be "air aware" and monitor your own air status.
- c. Maintain communications with the downed firefighter(s).
- d. Give periodic updates to the Incident Commander.
- e. See "Appendix E" for Search Considerations

5. When a member has been located, utilize the following acronym to assess the victim.

P Pass Alarm (deactivate so radio communications can be heard)

A Air status (victim's remaining air)

C Communications (give the Incident Commander an update)

P Position (where are you)

P Progress (current situation, location and victim status)

N Needs (resources or special equipment)

6. If a located member needs to be left behind because of a crew rotation it is important to "tie off" the victim. This will enable other rapid intervention crews to go directly to the victims' location in order to expedite the rescue effort.



VII. R.I.C. GROUP SUPERVISOR / R.I.C. OPERATIONS

Upon arrival of adequate resources, the Incident Commander shall designate at least one, three or four-person, Company to the R.I.C. Group Supervisor/R.I.C. positions. The Company Officer from the assigned company will fill the role of R.I.C. Group Supervisor. He or she will then assign the remainder of their crew as "R.I.C." and designate a leader. The early assignment of the R.I.C. Group Supervisor/R.I.C. ensures a seamless operation if a "Mayday/Firefighter Down" occurs.

A. R.I.C. Group Supervisor Responsibilities

1. Shall be responsible for maintaining accountability and communications.
 - a. Reports to the initial accountability collection point to get the first arriving units Accountability Board with attached Apparatus Tags.
 - b. Establishes the accountability collection point near the point of entry and maintains the Accountability Board.
 - c. Conducts the P.A.R. for assigned units within the I.D.L.H. environment when requested to do so by the Incident Commander.
 - i. Contact appropriate I.C.S. Supervisor and request a P.A.R. for their assigned units/members.
 - ii. MUST ensure that all units with Apparatus Tags on the Accountability Board are accounted for.
 - iii. Report results of P.A.R. back to Incident Commander. For example: "I.C., R.I.C. Group Supervisor; We have accountability for the following units: Calimesa Patrol 1, Medic Engine 552, Medic Engine 553...etc."
 - d. Maintains radio communications with the entry crew.
 - i. Monitors crew progress.
 - ii. Monitors incident conditions.
 - iii. Actively monitor radio traffic.
 - e. Performs a face-to-face briefing when relieving the Initial Standby Team
2. Assigns the remainder of the crew as "R.I.C." and designates a leader.
3. Shall provide a R.I.C. briefing to include the following:



- a. Identify current conditions, known hazards, incident layout (i.e. A, B, C, D Sides).
 - b. Location of committed personnel.
 - c. Plan of action if there is a "Mayday/Firefighter Down" situation.
4. Ensure that the minimum tool cache has been established.
 5. Ensure that a "360 Survey" has been completed
 - a. "Soften" the structure.
 - b. Secondary/escape ladders.
 - c. Utilities secured.
 - d. Incident type will dictate proactive measures.
 6. As the incident expands in size or complexity request additional resources to assist with R.I.C. Operations.
 - a. Consider requesting an Accountability Officer to maintain accountability for the incident.
 - b. On large incidents assign a R.I.C. at all entry points.
 - c. If there is a "Mayday/Firefighter Down" you WILL need multiple R.I.C.

B. R.I.C. Group Supervisor Procedures For A "Mayday/Firefighter Down" During an incident it is imperative that the R.I.C. Group Supervisor remain focused and monitor fire ground operations. It will be the responsibility of the R.I.C. Group Supervisor to develop a plan and manage the rescue operation of downed members.

1. Ensure that the Incident Commander has acknowledged the "Mayday/Firefighter Down" notification.
2. The following information should be obtained about the downed member(s). See "Appendix D" for the R.I.C. Group Supervisor Tactical Worksheet to use as an organizational aid:

L Location (where are they)?

U Unit (apparatus assigned to)?

N Name (who is it)?

A Assignment/Air Status (what were they doing and their remaining air)?



R Resources (what do they need)?

3. Prior to deployment, conduct a briefing with R.I.C. Advise them of the situation and plan of action. Be sure to ensure the following:
 - a. Incident layout (e.g., A, B, C, D sides)
 - b. The point of entry is the closest to the last known location of the downed firefighter based on the LUNAR report.
 - c. All members have the proper Personal Protective Equipment.
 - d. All members have the proper tools and equipment.
 - e. All members are on the proper radio frequency.
4. Maintain communications with downed member(s) and R.I.C.
5. Request additional resources for the R.I.C. Group to assign as additional R.I.C.
 - a. Additional R.I.C. will be numbered in order (e.g., R.I.C.-2, R.I.C.-3, R.I.C.-4, etc.)
 - b. As resources arrive give assignments and provide briefings prior to deployment.
6. Give periodic updates to the Incident Commander on progress and needs.

C. Rapid Intervention Crew Responsibilities All members assigned to R.I.C. shall remain outside of the hazardous area in a **full state of readiness** to provide immediate assistance to entry crew members in the event of a "Mayday/Firefighter Down" situation. R.I.C. members should be proactive prior to deployment to aid in a successful rescue operation (e.g., establishing minimum equipment cache, secondary and escape ladders, softening the structure and securing utilities). Each Rapid Intervention Crew will have a designated leader and will be numbered R.I.C.-1, R.I.C.-2, R.I.C.-3, etc.

1. Obtain briefing from the R.I.C. Group Supervisor. Ensure the following information is obtained.
 - a. Identify current conditions, known hazards, incident layout (i.e. A, B, C, D Sides).
 - b. Location of committed personnel.
 - c. Plan of action if there is a "Mayday/Firefighter Down" situation.
2. Maintain radio communications.



- a. R.I.C. Group Supervisor.
- b. Entry Crew(s).
- c. Actively monitor radio traffic.

3. Monitor incident for changing conditions.

4. Proactive measures (incident type will dictate proactive measures).

- a. A minimum equipment cache shall be established. See "Appendix F" for Minimum Equipment Cache.
- b. Perform a "360 Survey" to identify incident layout.
- c. "Soften" structures
 - i. Remove security bars.
 - ii. Force doors so that they may be easily opened.
 - iii. Open garage and roll-up doors.
 - iv. Consideration should be given when opening windows and doors; it could have an effect on fire conditions.
- d. Throw additional ladders
 - i. Secondary ladders to the roof
 - ii. Escape ladders to windows and balconies

D. Rapid Intervention Crew Deployment Procedures

1. Upon notification of a "Mayday/Firefighter Down" situation, R.I.C. members shall immediately report back to the R.I.C. Group Supervisor.
2. Obtain a briefing from the R.I.C. Group Supervisor of the situation and the plan of action. The R.I.C. Leader should ensure the following:
 - a. Incident layout (e.g., A, B, C, D sides)
 - b. The point of entry is the closest to the last known location of the downed firefighter based on the LUNAR report.
 - c. All members have the proper Personal Protective Equipment.
 - d. All members have the proper tools and equipment.
 - e. All members are on the proper radio frequency.



3. Upon entry into the area to be searched, the R.I.C. shall remain in a working team of two or more.

- a. Direct rescue efforts shall continue as the safety of the scene dictates.
- b. Be "air aware" and monitor your own air status.
- c. Maintain communications with the downed fire fighter(s).
- d. Coordinate efforts with additional R.I.C.
- e. Give periodic updates to the R.I.C. Group Supervisor.
- f. See "Appendix E" for Search Considerations.

4. When a member has been located, utilize the following acronym to assess the victim.

P Pass Alarm (deactivate so radio communications can be heard)

A Air status

C Communications (give the Incident Commander an update)

P Position

P Progress

N Needs

5. If a located member needs to be left behind because of a crew rotation it is important to "tie off" the victim. This will enable other rapid intervention crews to go directly to the victims' location in order to expedite the rescue effort.



Appendix A

IMMEDIATELY DANGEROUS TO LIFE OR HEALTH (I.D.L.H.) INCIDENTS

An atmosphere or condition that poses an immediate threat to life, would cause irreversible adverse health effects, or would impair an individual's ability to escape from a dangerous situation. Conditions present during an advanced (beyond incipient stage) interior structural fire create an I.D.L.H. Atmosphere. Other examples of I.D.L.H. conditions include, but are not limited to the following:

- Fires and earthquake damage to pre-1933 brick construction
- Fires and earthquake damage to facades (supported and unsupported)
- Fires in lightweight construction
- Potential flashover and backdraft conditions
- Roof ventilation operations
- Fires in occupancies with large basements or large spaces where getting lost is a high potential
- Multiple fire attack teams working inside and on upper floors.
- High rise fires
- Refinery fires
- Fires and other incidents in Metro Rail tunnels, mines and other subterranean locations
- Structural collapse from earthquakes, explosions, floods, wind, and other causes
- Confined Space Rescues
- Trench Rescues
- Swift Water Rescues
- High angle rescues
- Hazardous Materials Incidents
- Possible terrorism incidents
- Any other incident type with a potential exposure to I.D.L.H. conditions.



Appendix B

FIREFIGHTER SELF-SURVIVAL TECHNIQUES

- **Activation of P.A.S.S. Device**

- ✓ Activate after reporting your situation over the radio
- ✓ Immediately if unable to raise anybody on the radio or if unable to speak.
- ✓ The device must remain on until rescued.
- ✓ If the device interferes with radio communications, the downed member(s) may temporarily turn off the device to speak or listen.

- **Crews Stay Together** - Firefighters that become lost and or disoriented need to stay together. Locating the missing firefighters will be much easier if they remain as a team.

- **Follow The Hose or Tag Lines** - Firefighters should stay in contact with hose lines when possible. The hose line should always be treated as a safety line to the outside. Where tag line ropes are in use, follow the tag line to the exterior.

- **Searching for an Exit** - A lost firefighter should always attempt to get out of the hazard area. This would include breaching walls, breaking windows and forcing doors when possible. Where doors, windows or other egress is not available, firefighters should next attempt to reach an exterior wall. Once at the wall he/she will be able to search for doorways, windows, and hallways that generally lead to the outside.

- **Retreat to a Safe Refuge** - When a firefighter cannot find a way out, find a safe refuge area (e.g., another room). Do not remain in the hazardous area. If the location of the firefighter emergency changes, notify RGS/RIC/IC as soon as it is safe to do so.

- **Stay Calm and Conserve Air** - A conscious effort must be made to control breathing. Unnecessary talking or physical activity must be ceased. Firefighters must control and pace their physical exertion activities in order to extend their SCBA air supply.

- **SCBA Mask Filter** - If the SCBA air supply is depleted, the firefighter may use an article of safety clothing as a filter of toxic atmospheres. The filter may be placed in or over the mask's open inhalation area, or over the opening of the disconnected low-pressure hose. This shall only be used as a last resort.

- **Horizontal Position** - If a firefighter cannot get out, he/she should assume a horizontal position on the floor that maximizes the audible affects of the P.A.S.S. device. The firefighter should attempt to take this position at an exterior wall, doorway or hallway that maximizes quick discovery by rescue crews.

- **Flashlights/Tapping Noise** - If assuming a position to await rescuers, the firefighter(s) should attempt to position his or her flashlight toward the ceiling. This will enhance the rescuer's



ability to see the light and locate the downed firefighter. If able, the firefighter(s) should attempt tapping noises to assist rescuers. Updates via radio will also help if the rescuers are heard in a nearby area

Standard Operating Policies – Standard Operating Guidelines
Concise Table of Content – Volume 6
Community Risk Reduction -Fire Prevention Bureau – 610.00

- **610.00 – Community Risk Reduction Fire Prevention Bureau - Vol. 6**
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Standard Operating Policies – Standard Operating Guidelines
Concise Table of Content – Volume 6
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